



Activision making big bucks

Driven by the strong sales of its Call of Duty titles during the holidays, Activision Blizzard Inc posted supernormal fourth quarter income. Its stock rose to a five-year high.



Mutant indian scooter

The new Hero RNT scooter is like a mini stationwagon that has many features
<http://dgit.in/merahero>

Smart SoHo



Backlog – streamline and keep track of all your projects.

training session every year that has a new set of taxes being introduced.

GnuCash (<http://www.gnucash.org/>), is one such open source accounting tool which allows for double-entry accounting, management of stock / bonds and other investment accounts, generation of reports and graphs and even schedule transactions. Now if you were under the impression that accounting bank transactions need to be done manually then you'd be surprised that if you bank supports QIF/OFX/HBCI imports then you can download your transaction history and sync GnuCash to do it according to a schedule. While actually getting a transfer done requires multiple levels of verification, the records of the same will be reflected in your account books instantly.

Monitoring software

Monitoring software is where you get to put the squeeze on delinquents (harsh word for slackers!). This however, is not the primary usage scenario for such software, instead it is used to ensure that your sensitive company secrets don't make it outside your control zone. Leaks may happen due to carelessness or because someone takes an initiative to do so, these software monitor each company computer for regular updates, malware checks, activity logs and other attempts to plug data loss. Whether it could be a temporary move or

a permanent one is your decision but we're just putting it here since it is one of the most commonly used software in companies.

It's difficult to get an open source alternative for this category since a complete solution involves multiple software. Which is why, opting for individual open source software for each aspect makes more

sense. For installing web filters you can use Squid Proxy and SquidGuard which is a URL redirector. Or you can set all your company computers to use OpenDNS and then manually set filters, however, this gives the employee control over what you get to monitor. For activity monitoring you can use ActivTrak which gives you a web based dashboard to look at reports and employee screenshots.

Storage management

From contacts, leads, accounting details, tax history to every other thing under the sun, it's the data that gives your company the advantage over your competitors and losing the same would be disastrous. Which is why you should invest in a high end NAS or at least setup a NAS on your own using FreeNAS. We've covered this before so you can check our back issues for the same.

Data synchronisation with a NAS storage is not a constant affair unless you don't store files locally at all. So making use of Dropbox or Google Drive on your

computer to save your work is a prudent move. However, these services make use of deduplication which does offer some privacy concerns. This is why sensitive documents are better off in NAS storage which in turn can be synchronised with an online storage service that you've purchased.

Office suite

We don't know of any work environments that can do without a word processor, a spreadsheet software and other tools which make up an office suite. This segment has developed quite well and you have a host of options. You can use OpenOffice which supports all the popular file formats but moving files between two different software has often led to a skewed presentation of the document visually. So making use of an alternative is helpful, there are plenty of free alternatives like Apache Office, LibreOffice or even better – Google Drive which allows collaborative editing.

The software we've mentioned are needed for most offices out there, though



LibreOffice is an incredible open source office suite.

your core service might need more that what we've listed out here. Obviously you've tested out some which are even better than the ones we've mentioned here. Do write in to let us know.



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